one place to another cannot be considered as a state. The modern state unquestioningly requires a definite portion of the earth as its territory over which it has undisputed authority. Again, like the population, it is difficult to fix the limit of the territory. There may be states such as the Soviet Union with huge territory or small states such as Tuvalu, Nauru, Vatican City, Monaco, Maldives or Malta with territory as small as it can be. What matters is the geographic location of the states. Otherwise, it would not have been possible for a small foggy island in the Atlantic, Great Britain to hold its sway over the world for centuries. In fact, the United States also enjoyed a strategic location so unique that it was possible for it to follow the policy of isolationism in the past. The United States is also less vulnerable from land or naval attacks because of the huge water body (Atlantic Ocean) surrounding it. An approaching enemy can be intercepted in the mid-seas by the powerful US navy. Therefore, size does not really matter. What matters is how far a state is vulnerable or not, which again depends on a lot of geo-strategic calculations and political, economic and military factors, especially in this nuclear and space age.

Government

The third important element is the government, which is the political organization of the state. The government is like the eyes and ears of the state, and the state wills and acts through the government. Whatever may be the form of government, it is absolutely necessary to have a government. It is through the government that the sovereign will of the state is expressed. What should be the nature of the government is no doubt important as far as foreign policy orientation is considered, but it is tough to state what should be the ‘model’ government for a state. From Aristotle till the present day this is a puzzle to which there is no clear-cut answer. Therefore, there are democratic forms of government to authoritarian regimes in the world. What counts is that whether or not the government of a particular state is recognized by the governments of other countries. Once it receives this recognition, it becomes the legal representative of the country, for instance the case with Peoples Republic of China, which did not receive the recognition of the United States after its